

Chapter 118-9

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Before leaving, Liang Shi went downstairs and found that the breakfast shop downstairs had already opened.

She simply bought breakfast and left it upstairs before driving off.

By the time she arrived at the crew, daylight had already broken, and the timing was just right.

The filming location was a rented villa, even more extravagant than the Liang family's old mansion.

There were also some exterior scenes—the crew had built everything on location.

This luxurious place didn't just have their crew filming; there was another crew filming a Republican-era¹ drama in the back garden.

After Liang Shi arrived, she immediately went to the main makeup room to get her hair and makeup done. Four or five extras were getting ready at the same time.

Today, Liang Shi was filming scenes with Yan Xi.

In the script, her scenes with Yan Xi were all in the latter part. What they were filming now was still from their later scenes, but due to location constraints, they were shooting by location.

The crew had communicated about this in advance, so Liang Shi had already familiarized herself with the script.

But when she was getting her makeup done, Yan Xi hadn't arrived yet.

By the time Liang Shi's makeup was half done, Yan Xi arrived late, yawning, waving her hand like a lucky cat²: "Morning."

"Morning," Liang Shi replied.

As soon as Yan Xi sat down, her eyelids drooped and she couldn't keep them open.

Seeing this, Liang Shi asked her: "What did you do last night?"

"Writing papers," Yan Xi said. "And homework."

Liang Shi: "....."

She didn't understand the world of academic overachievers.

Though...

"Did you memorize your lines?" Liang Shi asked.

Yan Xi sat there like a puppet, letting the makeup artist manipulate her: "Memorized them. Know them super well."

Hearing this, Liang Shi felt somewhat relieved.

But Yan Xi said: "You don't trust me? Let me tell you, even though I've never acted before, everyone praises me for having natural talent."

Liang Shi: ".....That's good then."

After a while, Liang Shi added: "I don't trust myself. After all, I don't have much experience, so it would be bad if I dragged you down."

Yan Xi: "....."

Yan Xi was satisfied and lightly hummed: "Good that you know."

After a pause, she added: "Student Xu is an idol to many people at our school. Her learning ability is super strong. Don't embarrass her."

Liang Shi: ".....?"

Liang Shi thought of what Xu Qingzhu had learned recently from Sally and Lin Luoxi, and couldn't help sighing. Perhaps an academic overachiever's learning ability was reflected in all aspects.

In terms of drawing inferences from examples, integrating knowledge, and deriving new insights from old knowledge, Xu Qingzhu had indeed achieved perfection.

Liang Shi responded to her perfunctorily.

After their makeup and styling were finished, the two came out holding their scripts to rehearse.

Yan Xi was still somewhat tired, and even thick foundation couldn't hide her dark circles.

It wasn't until they were in the sunlight that Liang Shi discovered her dark circles were so heavy. Seeing her poor condition, she couldn't help worrying: "Can you still film like this?"

Yan Xi raised her hand and yawned again: "Yes, I'm not that delicate."

Liang Shi: "....."

Perhaps because Yan Xi's nanny wasn't here, Yan Xi's speech wasn't soft and sweet anymore.

She wasn't complaining to anyone either.

"You're underestimating the abilities of contemporary college students," Yan Xi said. "Last year I pulled an all-nighter gaming and still went to take an ex... *yawn* ...am."

Liang Shi: "....."

It seemed contemporary college students' abilities were just so-so.

But Liang Shi didn't say anything.

The initial scenes were simple. Before filming started, Yan Xi patted her forehead, then drank a bottle of ice water to wake herself up.

Once filming began, Liang Shi hadn't quite gotten into character, and Yan Xi was even worse.

The director had anticipated this situation and didn't say anything.

Two people who had just joined the crew filming together—wasting two or three takes was expected.

So they quickly rallied to film the second take. Liang Shi had already found her rhythm, but Yan Xi still wasn't quite there. That spirited face of hers showed no emotion when reciting her lines.

The director was naturally unsatisfied.

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After NG-ing seventeen times in a row, the director couldn't help losing his temper: "Yan Xi, can you do this? If not, let's get a replacement."

A stern voice came from behind: "Then let's replace her."

Everyone in the crew turned around in unison to look at the newcomer. The speaker was wearing a black coat over a long dress, with long curly hair—grape purple that only showed in the sunlight. She stood there with upright posture, a coat draped over her arm.

Standing beside her was a glamorous beauty, wearing a light blue long coat that reached her knees over a burgundy sweater and dark jeans—a very ordinary outfit, but paired with that face, everything became extraordinary.

Her pupils were light brown, appearing indifferent to everything under the sunlight.

Especially with that face, which carried a world-weary quality.

Distant and cold.

Liang Shi looked at the newcomers in a daze for a few seconds. Standing across from her, Yan Xi, who had been somewhat dejected, immediately brightened up: "Jiejie! Sister Hui!"

The director's expression wasn't good, feeling he'd provoked yet another big Buddha he couldn't afford to offend.

Yan Lin stood there waiting for Yan Xi to run over, handing her the coat: "Aren't you afraid of freezing?"

Yan Xi waved it away, not taking it, only asking: "Weren't you supposed to be on a date with Sister Hui today? Why did you come looking for me?"

Standing not far away, Liang Shi's heart skipped—A date?

Footnotes:

- ¹ Republican-era (民国): Refers to the Republic of China period (1912-1949), a popular setting for Chinese historical dramas featuring early 20th century fashion and culture.
- ² Lucky cat (招财猫): Also known as Maneki-neko, a common Japanese/Chinese figurine of a cat with one paw raised in a beckoning gesture, believed to bring good luck and fortune.